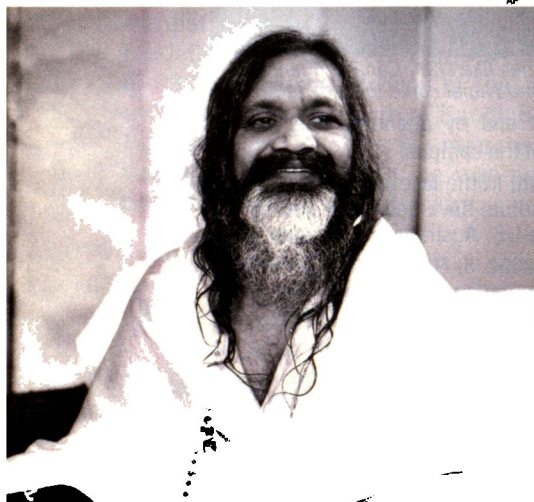


MAHARISHI MAHESH YOGI [1917-2008]

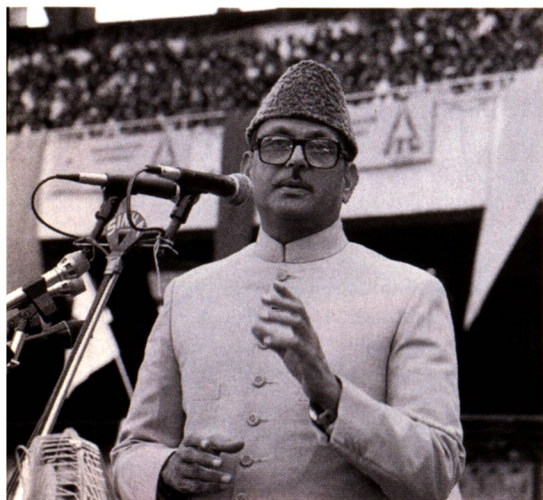
The "flying yogi" who inspired a cult following in the 1960s and '70s with his mix of Indian spirituality and mysticism. His followers included the Beatles, Mick Jagger of the Rolling Stones and Indo-American author Deepak Chopra. Some called him the Giggling Guru for his high-pitched laugh. Born Mahesh Prasad Varma, he was the architect of the hoary concept of transcendental meditation and made Hindu seem synonymous with Hippie.

AP



BABA AMTE [1914-2008]

Murlidhar Devidas Amte aka Baba Amte, a social reformer who transformed millions of lives with his selfless and tireless work among the least privileged. He strived to ensure a life of dignity for the discriminated, deprived and dispossessed.



DAS SAIBAL



“Tendulkar's plays derived inspiration from real-life incidents or social upheavals.”

VIJAY TENDULKAR [1928-2008]

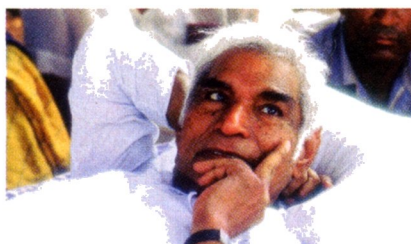
Marathi playwright who showcased contemporary and unconventional themes in *Grushastha*, *Amchyavar Kon Prem Karnar*, *Shrimant*, *Shantata! Court Chalu Aah* and *Ghasiram Kotwal*.

HARKISHEN SINGH SURJEET [1916-2008]

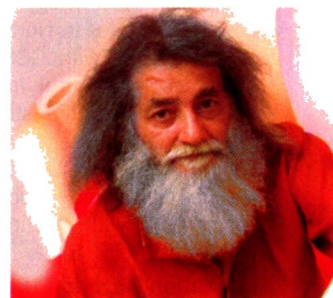
The former CPI(M) general secretary brought the Marxists to the Centre, brokering the V.P. Singh government in 1989 and then the H.D. Deve Gowda and I.K. Gujral governments. He was one of the 32 members of the CPI who walked out of the party to form the CPI(M) in 1964. He was one of the first members of the Politburo, a position he held for 44 years.

HABIB MIAN [1870-2008]

India's oldest man was born at Rajgarh in Rajasthan and worked as a clarinet player for the Jaipur royal family in his youth.



SHARAD SAXENA



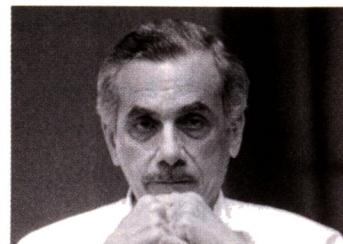
MANJIT BAWA [1941-2008]

He was one of the greatest Indian figurative artists at a time when Indian artistic sensibilities were influenced by abstract European images. His paintings were vibrant in colour and forms. Hugely influenced by Sufism, his images of the cattle of rural Punjab and the flute-playing Krishna came to acquire undercurrents of spirituality and influence scores of admirers and fellow artists.

“The Mandal Messiah was the great subverter of Indian politics.”

VISHWANATH PRATAP SINGH [1931-2008]

He implemented the infamous Mandal Commission report (which recommended 27.5 per cent reservation in government jobs for the obc) in 1990. Mandal, with caste as its core and merit its casualty, divided the mind of India and made V.P. Singh our first prime minister to lead a minority government, the great disrupter of social hierarchy.



RUSSY K. KARANJIA [1913-2008]

Journalist and the original tabloid guru, he founded the first Indian tabloid *Blitz* in 1941. He was known for his hard-hitting editorials and his penchant for courting controversies.